internal security, of a police force that is traditionally Sephardi? Of course, it would also be meaningful for all ordinary Shas members.

Are we, the liberal-left, just pretending that all of this will help? That Biden, Macron, and all the Alsheichs will help? Or are we merely whistling past the graveyard? The fact is that in Israel's short history there have been surprising moves in both political directions: from left to right and from right to left.

From left to right? The most unexpected and grotesque example is the sudden commitment of some of the best-known Israeli writers, all of them traditional leftists, to the "whole of Eretz Israel" (Eretz Israel Hashlema) movement advocating the annexation of the conquered Palestinian territories in the aftermath of the Six-Day War. Adherents included the national poet, Nathan Alterman, and other well-known writers such as Haim Gouri and Moshe Shamir.

From right to left? The best example is the architect of the Likud and main promoter of the settlement policy, Ariel Sharon, who, as defense minister under Begin, led the First Lebanon War and was an accomplice to the Sabra and Shatila massacres. After becoming prime minister in 2001, Sharon accepted the need to get rid of the Gaza Strip; following the Likud's violent opposition, "Arik" left the party and created a new one, Kadima (Forward); he had apparently decided to get out of major parts of the West Bank, too, had he not suffered a stroke that put an end to his political career and ultimately his life.

Who could be the next Arik? Back to earth: stop dreaming!

Saturday, February 4

Much depends on tonight's protests: if the numbers grow, there is a slight chance that the regime change can be blocked. Otherwise, I do not know what else can help. The former attorney general, Avichai Mandelblit, put it